Nehru answered the wild allegation in appropriate terms. Khushwant Singh has now done the same effectively in the newspapers. The preoccupation, indeed, an obsession with truth in the original Hindu scriptures cannot escape any reader. This attitude towards the Indian civilisation is connected with the retrospective vindication of British rule. This is also linked with the fairly common left-handed compliment paid to Jawaharlal Nehru as 'India's last governor general'. The idea is that the momentum of British ethos survived during the leadership of this most British of Indian politicians.

According to the intelligence analysts, these allegations and wild thoughts about a religion would have had very little immediate significance if it were not for the fact that there was a lobby in the USA which had similar ideas. Although, not much was revealed in the public domain about the CIA's penetration in the Middle East, it was a fact that the Americans had a big stake in the region. A secret note from the MEA in 1979 had informed the Indian government that the USA was training the Saudi intelligence service and that the CIA kept an eye on internal developments in Saudi Arabia. In 1948, after Independence, the Indian government had opened a consulate at Jeddah which was raised to the status of consulate general in 1954. In 1961, India established its embassy in the city with an emphasis on a policy of peace. But after King Faisal came to power in 1964, his inclination towards PanIslamism opened avenues for Pakistan's antiIndia propaganda, resulting in a tilt in Saudi policy in favour of Pakistan. This increased India's anxiety and the country strengthened its monitoring of anti-India propaganda. When the attack on Hinduism exploded, intelligence operatives perceived it as a move to weaken India's global influence. The analysts said: